GRAMMARFIRST · FREE SAMPLE

# Russian Grammar Compact

30 lessons from A1 to B2 with rules, examples, tips and exercises. Answers included.



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# How this workbook works

Grammar is the frame of a language. Once you understand the rules, you can build your own sentences instead of memorising phrases. This workbook walks you through the essential grammar of Russian step by step.

Every lesson has four parts: the **rule**, the **structure** at a glance, **examples** with translation and a **tip**. Then come five **exercises**. The answers are at the end of the workbook.

The chapters follow the levels of the Common European Framework: A1, A2 and B1. At the end of a level you have worked through its grammar once completely.

With the GrammarFirst app you can practise every lesson interactively too, with audio, spaced review and Mila the marmot.

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Free sample: lessons 1 to 3 of 30. Get the full workbook at fabio-ecosystem-ashy.vercel.app/grammarfirst/premium

# Unit 1 · Basics

A1

## 1 Greetings

Russian distinguishes between informal and formal 'you'. 'Привет' is casual, 'Здравствуйте' polite.

> **Привет (privét) · Здравствуйте (zdrávstvujte) · Спасибо (spasíbo) · Пожалуйста (pozhálujsta)**

| Situation | Hello | Goodbye |
|---|---|---|
| formal | Здравствуйте | До свидания |
| casual | Привет | Пока |
| morning | Доброе утро | Хорошего дня |
| evening | Добрый вечер | Спокойной ночи |

| | |
|---|---|
| **Привет! Как дела?** | Hi! How are you? (privét, kak delá) |
| **Здравствуйте!** | Good day! (polite) |
| **Спасибо, хорошо.** | Thanks, fine. (spasíbo, khoroshó) |

**Tip** 'Пожалуйста' means please and also you're welcome.

**More** Здравствуйте is polite and used for several people, Привет is casual among friends. The first в in здравствуйте is silent: [zdrástvujte]. Пожалуйста means 'please' and also 'you're welcome'. Saying goodbye: До свидания (formal), Пока (casual).

### Exercises

1. **Greet politely (your boss, female):**
   a) Привет  b) Здравствуйте  c) Пока
2. **Match**
   1. Спасибо _____ A. bye
   2. Пожалуйста _____ B. thank you
   3. Привет _____ C. please
   4. Пока _____ D. hello
3. **'Как дела?' means …**
   a) What's your name?  b) How are you?  c) Where do you live?
4. **Write 'thank you' in transliteration:** _____
5. **Translate: Thanks, fine.**

_____

## 2 No 'to be' in the present

In the present tense 'to be' is simply left out. 'Это' means 'this is / these are'.

> **Я студент. = I am a student. · Это мой дом. = This is my house.**

| Russian | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Я студент. | I am a student. |
| Ты дома? | Are you at home? |
| Это моя мама. | This is my mother. |
| Он в офисе. | He is in the office. |
| Где метро? | Where is the metro? |

| | |
|---|---|
| **Я врач.** | I am a doctor. (ya vrach) |
| **Она дома.** | She is at home. (oná dóma) |
| **Это Анна.** | This is Anna. (éto Ánna) |

**Tip** Russian has no articles: 'Это книга' can mean 'a book' or 'the book'.

**More** In the present tense 'to be' is dropped: Я врач (I am a doctor). In writing a dash stands between two nouns: Москва — столица России. There are no articles: дом means 'house', 'a house' or 'the house'. In the past and future you need быть: Я был врачом.

### Exercises

1. **I am a teacher.**
   a) Я есть учитель.  b) Я учитель.  c) Я быть учитель.
2. **Translate: This is my brother.**

   _____
3. **Match the pronouns**
   1. я _____ A. I
   2. ты _____ B. you
   3. он _____ C. she
   4. она _____ D. he
4. **'Мы дома' means …**
   a) We are at home.  b) Our house.  c) We are going home.
5. **'This is' in Russian:** _____

## 3 Three genders

You can usually tell the gender by the ending: consonant masculine, -а/-я feminine, -о/-е neuter.

> **он: дом, стол · она: мама, книга · оно: окно, море**

| Gender | Ending | Example | he / she / it |
|---|---|---|---|
| masculine | consonant, -й, -ь | дом, музей, день | он |
| feminine | -а, -я, -ь | мама, неделя, ночь | она |
| neuter | -о, -е, -мя | окно, море, время | оно |

| | |
|---|---|
| **дом** | house (m) |
| **книга** | book (f) |
| **окно** | window (n) |

**Tip** Watch out: папа (dad) ends in -a but is masculine.

**More** You can almost always tell the gender by the ending: consonant = masculine, -а/-я = feminine, -о/-е = neuter. With -ь (soft sign) you have to learn it: день (m), ночь (f). Male people in -a stay masculine: папа, дедушка. Gender decides adjective and past-tense endings.

### Exercises

1. **книга is …**
   a) masculine  b) feminine  c) neuter
2. **окно is …**
   a) masculine  b) feminine  c) neuter
3. **Which word is masculine?**
   a) машина  b) стол  c) море
4. **Match**
   1. дом ..... A. он
   2. мама ..... B. оно
   3. море ..... C. она
   4. папа ..... D. он
5. **Pronoun for 'окно':** _____



## Want more?

27 more lessons with answers are waiting in the full workbook.

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